15 October 2026

# MORNING REPORT

Today's economic developments and market movements.

## Key themes

Concerns over more persistent US inflation weighed heavily on risk sentiment overnight, with the initial reaction to the September CPI particularly sharp before some of the moves retraced over the course of trading.

Share markets took a hit as the slight upside surprise on US inflation drove a renewed sell-off in chipmakers, with the S&P 500 down 1.2% and the NASDAQ falling 1.9%, while European equities bucked the weaker trend.

Treasuries faced immense selling pressure immediately following the CPI as the implied odds of an October Fed hike jumped from around 20% to over 50%, though the move largely retraced as the session wore on and markets ultimately settled on a 35% chance.

Oil prices remained elevated amid ongoing disruption in the Strait of Hormuz and escalating Saudi–Houthi tensions, with Brent edging 0.3% higher to US$106/bbl.

## Data snapshot

| FX Last 24 hrs | Current | Change |
|---|---|---|
| TWI | 65.0 | 0.5% |
| AUD/USD | 0.6973 | -0.2% |
| AUD/JPY | 110.40 | -0.2% |
| AUD/GBP | 0.5285 | 0.3% |
| AUD/NZD | 1.2469 | 0.2% |
| AUD/EUR | 0.6249 | 0.2% |
| AUD/CNH | 4.6679 | -0.1% |
| AUD/SGD | 0.8960 | 0.2% |
| AUD/HKD | 5.4725 | -0.1% |
| AUD/CAD | 0.9927 | 0.0% |
| EUR/USD | 1.1157 | -0.4% |
| USD/JPY | 158.32 | 0.0% |
| USD Index | 102.54 | 0.4% |

| AUS Interest Rate Swaps | Last | Change |
|---|---|---|
| 30 day BBSY | 4.63 | 0.00 |
| 90 day BBSY | 4.82 | 0.00 |
| 180 day BBSY | 5.21 | 0.01 |
| 1 year swap | 4.91 | 0.01 |
| 2 year swap | 4.92 | 0.01 |
| 3 year swap | 4.93 | 0.01 |
| 4 year swap | 4.97 | 0.02 |
| 5 year swap | 5.00 | 0.03 |
| 6 year swap | 5.05 | 0.03 |
| 7 year swap | 5.10 | 0.03 |
| 8 year swap | 5.15 | 0.03 |
| 9 year swap | 5.19 | 0.03 |
| 10 year swap | 5.23 | 0.03 |

| Equities | Close | Change |
|---|---|---|
| S&P/ASX 200 | 8,728 | -0.6% |
| S&P 500 | 7,712 | -1.2% |
| Japan Nikkei | 67,744 | 0.0% |
| Hang Seng | 24,314 | -0.1% |
| Euro Stoxx 50 | 6,190 | 0.4% |
| UK FTSE100 | 10,725 | 0.7% |
| VIX Index | 16.95 | 11.0% |

| Government Bond Yields | Close | Change |
|---|---|---|
| **Australia** | | |
| 3 year bond | 4.91 | 0.03 |
| 10 year bond | 5.32 | 0.03 |
| **United States** | | |
| 3-month T Bill | 4.09 | 0.02 |
| 2 year bond | 4.81 | 0.02 |
| 10 year bond | 5.19 | -0.02 |
| **Other (10 year yields)** | | |
| Germany | 3.47 | 0.00 |
| Japan | 3.00 | -0.01 |
| UK | 5.42 | -0.02 |

| Commodities | Current | Change |
|---|---|---|
| CRB Index | 416.03 | -0.5% |
| Gold | 4102.98 | -1.4% |
| Copper | 14490 | -0.6% |
| Oil (WTI futures) | 95.10 | 1.0% |
| Coal (coking) | 266.00 | -0.4% |
| Coal (thermal) | 151.75 | -0.9% |
| Iron Ore | 90.30 | -0.1% |
| ACCU | 36.13 | -4.3% |

| Sydney Futures Exchange | Current | Change |
|---|---|---|
| 10 yr bond | 5.33 | 0.00 |
| 3 yr bond | 4.93 | 0.01 |
| 3 mth bill rate | 4.77 | 0.00 |
| SPI 200 | 8,724 | -0.2% |

Data as at 7:00am AEST. Change is from the previous trading day (excluding the SFE, which is the change during the night session). Source: Bloomberg.

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## Financial Markets

- Share markets took a hit as the slight upside surprise on US inflation curbed risk sentiment, driving a sell-off in chipmakers. The S&P 500 (–1.2%) ad NASDAQ (–1.9%) both fell sharply. In contrast, the Euro Stoxx 50 (+0.4%) and London's FTSE 100 (+0.7%) both rose, the latter buoyed by the Bank of England's chief economist downplaying expectations for a run of multiple rate hikes in the UK. Stocks were generally in the red across Asia, led by further sharp declines in Shanghai (–1.4%), smaller falls across Seoul (–0.4%) and Hong Kong (–0.1%), while Tokyo was broadly flat. The ASX 200 meanwhile dropped 0.6%, largely retracing the week's gains so far, and futures markets point to another weak open this morning.
- Treasuries faced immense selling pressure in the immediate aftermath of the US CPI, with yields up double digits across much of the curve after the odds of a follow-up October Fed rate hike jumped from circa 20% to over 50%. These moves retraced over the course of the session, with the 2Y finishing 2bps higher while the 10Y fell 2bps. Markets have settled on a 35% chance of a Fed rate hike in October, with a three rate hikes in total still priced in by mid-2027. Yields were mixed across the globe: 10Y Bund flat, 10Y Gilt down 2bps, 10Y JGB down 1bp, while ACGB yields lifted.
- The USD found a strong bid, the DXY surging from 102.2 to 102.9, before settling 0.4% higher at around 102.5. The Euro and Sterling were the main pairs to slide against the greenback, down 0.4% and 0.5% to around USD1.115 and USD1.319 respectively, both probing cycle lows intraday. The Yen meanwhile held its ground, trading a tighter range and recovering after the initially sell-off back to around JPY158.3.
- The Aussie dollar meanwhile lost some ground on the day, down 0.2%, but remains within recent ranges. Today's labour force data is unlikely to throw a major spanner in the works as far as monetary policy is concerned – the RBA's immediate focus is clearly centred on inflation, especially the risks emanating from the Middle East – although another weak read on unemployment would continue to complicate the RBA's communication challenge, especially given the more hawkish minutes received earlier this week.
- Crude oil continues to trade a tight range at elevated levels amid ongoing attacks on ships transiting the Strait of Hormuz and an escalating conflict between Saudi Arabia and the Houthis. On the day, Brent rose 0.3% to US$106.0/bbl. Ongoing tit-for-tat strikes between Russia and Ukraine on energy infrastructure are an added complication for the refined product market, namely diesel.
- Base metals were generally weaker amid the pull-back in risk sentiment, with LME copper and aluminium down 0.6% and 1.7% to US$14,490/mt and US$2,988/mt respectively.

## Today's key data and events

| Time | Event | Exp | Prev |
|---|---|---|---|
| 10:50 | JP Machinery Orders Aug | 2.3% | -3.7% |
| 11:30 | AU Employment Sep | 20k | 39.5k |
| 11:30 | AU Unemployment Rate Sep | 4.6% | 4.6% |
| 15:30 | JP Industrial Production Aug Final | - | -1.7% |
| 17:00 | GB Trade Balance Aug | -£4150b | -£3450b |
| 20:00 | EZ Industrial Production Aug | 0.0% | -0.1% |
| 23:30 | US Retail Sales Sep | 0.3% | 1.2% |
| 23:30 | US Fed Empire State Manufacturing Oct | 12.3pts | 7.6pts |
| 23:30 | US Phily Fed Manufacturing Oct | 28pts | 37.8pts |
| 23:30 | US Initial Jobless Claims 10/10/2026 | 200k | 197k |
| 23:30 | US PPI Sep | 0.6% | 0.4% |
| 1:00 | US Business Inventories Aug | 0.4% | 0.8% |

Times are AEST. All data forecasts are m/m or q/q and seasonally adjusted unless otherwise specified. Forecasts for Australian data are our forecasts and for other countries they are consensus forecasts.

Gold meanwhile pulled back sharply following the US CPI and surge in real yields, down 0.6% to just above US$4,100/oz, back toward the bottom of recent ranges.

## International Data

In the US, the **CPI** rose 0.6% (3.7%yr) on a headline basis in September, broadly as expected. However, the 0.3% (2.6%yr) increase in core inflation was slightly larger than expected. Within the core components, core goods prices were up 0.3% after being broadly flat over the past 6 months (0.7%yr). Core services meanwhile rose 0.4% (3.1%yr) as a result of a 0.4% increase in shelter (3.2%yr) but also a 0.6% gain for transport services and a 0.3% increase in medical care services (2.7%yr and 2.5%yr respectively).

The October **Beige Book** reported moderate growth in 2 of the 12 Federal Reserve Districts. Of the other 10, 8 saw modest or slight growth and 2 no significant change. Most regions saw little or no change in overall consumer spending, with high-income households driving much of the growth observed. On the labour market, most districts assessed little or no net change in employment. Observations on price growth meanwhile continued to point to lingering risks, with 3 districts characterising overall price growth as robust and 8 moderate. Of the latter group, 3 noted that input price pressures were intensifying, if not already growing robustly.

The **FOMC's Barkin** said the CPI report was stronger than he would have hoped, and that he will be watching PPI data closely. **Bowman** repeated her patient stance: "We have some time to wait and see how financial conditions and the economy evolves before we decide that we need to take any more action … I don't feel any urgency for taking further action at this point … We really need to take some time and understand how things will evolve within the economy".

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